SOFTWARE ENGINEERING • STARTUP PITCH

SKILLBRIDGE

Turning digital skills into real opportunities.

A mobile-first learning and opportunity platform for underserved young people.

Prepared for: PLP Software Engineering Pitch Deck Assignment

Talent is everywhere. Access is not.

Young people can be motivated to learn, but often lack a clear bridge from learning to earning.

Learning is fragmented

Free lessons, videos and courses are spread across many websites. Learners struggle to choose a path and stay consistent.

Connectivity is limited

Data costs, shared devices and unreliable internet make large platforms difficult to use every day.

Opportunities are hard to find

Learners may finish a course but still lack a portfolio, mentor feedback or access to trusted opportunities.

Result: effort does not always translate into demonstrable skills, confidence or income.

One guided path from learning to opportunity

Skill Bridge combines short learning plans, practical projects, mentoring and opportunity discovery.

1. Learn

Follow a simple, skill-based roadmap with short lessons and progress tracking.

2. Build

Complete small projects and save work samples to a personal portfolio.

3. Get feedback

Request mentor reviews, peer support and practical improvement tips.

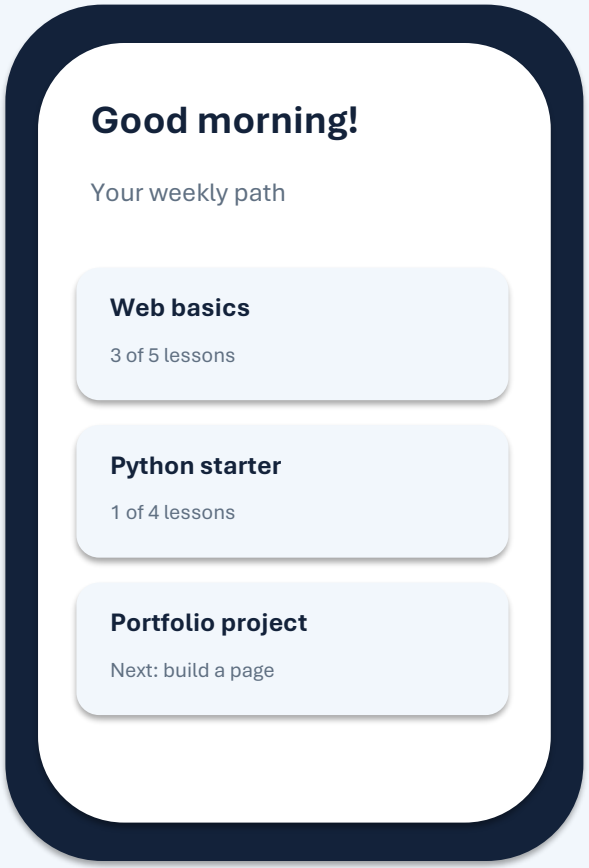
4. Connect

Find relevant internships, volunteering and entry-level opportunities.

Designed for mobile first, low bandwidth and gradual access to offline-friendly content.

A simple learner journey

The first version focuses on the smallest set of features that delivers useful value.



- Personal dashboard with goals, progress and next steps
- Short lessons and downloadable learning resources
- Project submissions with simple feedback
- Learner portfolio with shareable project links
- Opportunity board with clear eligibility and deadlines

Start focused. Expand with evidence.

Initial users are learners who need a practical, affordable route into digital work.

Primary users

Young people aged 16–30

- Students and recent graduates
- Refugee and host communities
- Self-taught beginner developers

Partner customers

Organizations that support youth

- NGOs and training centers
- Schools and community hubs
- Employers seeking entry-level talent

Expansion path

Prove demand in one community first, then expand to other learning hubs and regions based on retention, outcomes and partner demand.

Market sizing will be validated through interviews, pilot enrollment and partner commitments—not unsupported estimates.

A bridge—not just another course library

Skill Bridge is designed to make learning visible, practical and connected to next steps.

For learners

A clear plan, practical projects, a portfolio and guidance toward relevant opportunities.

For organizations

A way to support learners, monitor participation and identify skills gaps using simple progress data.

For employers

A clearer view of candidates' practical work, learning progress and motivation—not only certificates.

Core promise: learn with direction, build proof of skill, and discover a realistic next step.

Keep learning free; earn through partners

A blended model can protect access while creating a path to sustainability.

Free learner access

Core learning paths, progress tracking and portfolio tools remain free for individuals.

Organization plans

Partners pay for cohort management, reporting, tailored learning paths and facilitator tools.

Sponsored programs

Employers, foundations or NGOs sponsor training cohorts, project challenges or mentorship.

Early-stage assumption: validate willingness to pay with 5–10 partner interviews before setting prices.

Different tools solve different parts of the journey

Skill Bridge differentiates through a guided, low-bandwidth path from learning to proof of skill.

Feature	Course platforms	Social groups	Skill Bridge
Structured learning path	Strong	Limited	**Strong**
Practical portfolio	Varies	Unstructured	**Built in**
Mentor / peer feedback	Varies	Informal	**Organized**
Opportunity connection	Limited	Unverified	**Curated**
Low-bandwidth design	Varies	Often light	**Priority**

These are initial hypotheses; competitor research and user testing will refine the comparison.

Build a reliable MVP before adding complexity

A simple architecture keeps the first version testable, maintainable and affordable.

Frontend

Responsive web app

HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Mobile-first interface

Backend & data

Python / Django or Node.js

REST API

PostgreSQL database

Trust & reliability

Secure authentication

Role-based access

Backups, privacy and monitoring

Weeks 1–2

Interview users

Define requirements

Weeks 3–5

Build learning paths

and learner profiles

Weeks 6–8

Add projects, portfolio

and basic reporting

Weeks 9–10

Pilot, measure, improve

and fix issues

Earn trust locally, then grow

Start with a small pilot so the team can learn quickly and demonstrate outcomes.

- Recruit 30–50 learners through a school, training center or youth organization
- Run a 6–8 week pilot with weekly check-ins and practical project work
- Partner with volunteer mentors and local employers
- Share learner projects and verified outcomes—with consent
- Use feedback and retention data to improve before scaling

Pilot success measures

- Learners who complete the path
- Projects submitted and reviewed
- Weekly active learners
- Learner satisfaction
- Mentors and partners retained

Target: validate the model—not claim scale too early.

Measure progress, not just sign-ups

The pilot will establish a baseline and track whether learners make meaningful progress.

Activation	Learners who complete onboarding
Engagement	Weekly active learners and lesson completion
Skill proof	Projects completed and reviewed
Confidence	Change in self-reported confidence
Opportunity	Interviews, placements or next-step enrollments

All targets will be set after baseline research and reviewed with pilot partners.

Help us test the bridge from learning to opportunity

We are seeking pilot partners, mentors and early feedback to turn this concept into a useful product.

Pilot partners

Help recruit learners and shape the first learning paths.

Mentors

Review projects, give feedback and support learner confidence.

Technical feedback

Help us test the MVP, improve usability and protect user data.

Skill Bridge: learn with direction. Build proof. Take the next step.